



Sixty percent of freelancers are women

still partake in the economy. Outsourcers get highly skilled personnel for a fraction of the cost, while homemakers can make money on the side without compromising on family time. Plus, women seem to prefer the diversity of work, so they're not bored. Overall, this is one field that I feel will be female dominated.

THE CELL PHONE

What started as a simple communication device has now, in all honesty, become the new PC. Computing has never been more personal than on a cell phone, and the focus has shifted from creating to using. The chauvinists amongst us will be sniggering right about now, and whispering "selfies" and "Candy Crush" under their breaths.

However, I think cell phones have exposed a large part of humanity to technology, and opened their minds to trying it out. It's also resulted in the next generation being exposed to it a lot sooner. Boy or girl, doesn't matter, they all want to play with their parents' phones. That's how it starts, and then a whole generation of people are used to being aided by technology, and they seek even more of the same.

Then there's the access to the internet pie, which is again skewed towards men. This is also ending soon, hopefully, as more and more services go online and as mobiles take over as the primary device for accessing the internet.

LET'S PUT A PIN IN THAT!

The problem with a totalitarian equality is that it assumes all things are equal, but all things aren't. There are some fundamental differences between men and women, and this is especially true in the case of reproduction. Men just have a slower biological clock (in general) when it comes to being able to create an offspring. Every human deserves the right to become a parent, however, the clock ticks faster for women. This

means that men can focus more single-mindedly on careers, but women have to start worrying about whether they're getting too old to become mothers.

Large corporates such as Facebook and Apple offer to foot the bill for women who want to have their eggs frozen. This at least allows some women to focus on their careers. Perhaps the day will come when all babies are grown in test tubes, and are born to 40-year old parents, raised by robot nannies, with both parents taking equal time off from their jobs... until then, this is a pretty decent halfway measure.

BROADBAND

Assuming that the internet penetration across the globe keeps increasing, the internet is going to be the greatest leveller of them all. Why? Because the internet doesn't care whether you are male or female.

Well, OK, that's a lie, because advertisers care a great deal, so that they can market multicoloured phone covers to a woman, and primary coloured phones to men. They pay good money to know your gender, which is one of the main reasons why Facebook is worth as much as it is!

What I meant was that the information on the internet is available to all. It's there for everyone to use regardless of gender. If you're looking for ways to learn how to code, or take up baking a cake, no one's going to judge you. This, I hope, will finally end the whole gender differences once and for all.

<rant>The only problem is, internet penetration is increasing, but not equally for both genders, sadly. There are still too many countries where people believe that the net is bad. As if it's a living breathing entity enticing people to sin. In many patriarchal societies, women aren't allowed access to phones and devices, let

alone internet access. We live in one such country, sadly, where we blame everything else but our patriarchal and bigoted mind-sets.</rant>

UX DESIGN

This is an area where we need to see many more women. For one thing, at least half of all buyers out there are women, and they usually spend more than men. If you're selling products online, chances are you need to design more for female shoppers than male. Yes, that's sexist, but the fact is that women are usually left handling home affairs. There are many more things bought for the home, and on a much more regular basis than, say, phones or gadgets that men traditionally show interest in. Shopping malls are designed with women in mind, especially the grocery and household item sections.

UX design almost comes naturally to those who are more intuitive, are willing to listen to others, are able to multi-task, separate words from emotions (of the people being researched) and able to express themselves clearly... sounds like the perfect job for women!

EVERYTHING ELSE!

Everything you've read up until now is just a load of bull droppings. Honest. I was just cherry picking random stuff from technology to try and make points about why they're good avenues for women to pursue. Absolutely anything in technology, or even otherwise, can be analysed like this. You can choose to see the glass half-full or half-empty, or consider something to be a male bastion, or not, it's really merely a way of looking at things. The fact of the matter is, your sex, gender, or even sexuality (which sex you're attracted to) means absolutely nothing when it comes to what you're capable of learning or achieving.

The future, as I see it, is set already. Technology will expose more and more generations of humanity to information, which will in turn allow them to understand what you and I already know. All this nonsense of what men should and shouldn't do, or what women can and cannot do will soon be moot, hopefully. Maybe someday the first question about a brand new life will not be: "Is it a boy or a girl?" but instead be: "Are you hoping it will grow up to be a programmer or a UX designer?" Wouldn't that be nice? 



Robot nannies for career women